Dataset Facts

Dataset Panel Study of Income Dynamics (PSID): CDS and TAS
Unit of Observation One individual per row in each extract; CDS records span multiple waves, while TAS contains 2021 records
Dataset Size CDS: 21,511 rows, 116 columns; TAS: 2,362 rows, 25 columns

Motivation

Original Authors University of Michigan's Survey Research Center
Original Use Case Study family economic conditions, child development, and transitions into adulthood
Funding PSID receives support from federal agencies, including NIH and NSF

Composition

Sample or Complete Longitudinal sample of children and young adults from PSID families, not the full U.S. population
Missing Data Nonresponse, attrition, and wave-specific ineligibility; CDS also has missing participation or linkage information
Sensitive Information Individual and family identifiers, caregiver relationships, income, education, and employment

Collection Process

Sampling Strategy Probability-based PSID sample; CDS and TAS eligibility varies by wave
Collection Period CDS cumulative file includes 1997–2024 wave information; TAS extract uses 1997 family background and 2021 adult outcomes
Ethical Review Wave-specific review status to be verified
Consent Voluntary survey participation; wave-specific consent procedures to be verified

Preprocessing

Cleaning Done None documented
Labeling Done Complex variables: data uses alphanumeric variable strings to handle thousands of historical questions

Uses and Distribution

Notable Uses Track long-term economic, social, and health changes across American families and their descendants over multiple generations
Raw Data Available Yes, raw data is accessible but is distributed based on data sensitivity
Format and Terms The Open Database License (ODbL)
Redistribution Users can freely share, modify, and use this Database while maintaining this same freedom for others

Maintenance

Updates Starting in 1999, the PSID collected data biennially and data updates are announced directly on the PSID News Section
Maintainers Faculty and researchers at the University of Michigan's Institute for Social Research (ISR)

Limitations: Does not estimate pure point-in-time cross-sectional (or static) demographic statistics for the general U.S. population
Sources: PSID Overview; CDS-TAS Study Design; CDS-TAS FAQ; PSID Conditions of Use

Figure 1: A data card styled after nutrition labels. Created for the retrospective BookCorpus datasheet, with help from Stack Exchange. See Gebru et al. for guidance on creating complete datasheets for datasets.